

Manager Coaching for Sales Performance

EuroBridge Capital Solutions

Participant Workbook and Manager Toolkit

Designed for a 2-hour facilitated workshop for sales managers, product-line managers, and team leads.

Branding: deep navy, gold accent, executive financial services tone.

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook supports the 2-hour Manager Coaching for Sales Performance workshop. Use it to complete reflection activities, diagnose sales performance gaps, practice the S.C.O.R.E. Coaching Model, and create your two-week coaching action plan.

Key idea: Coaching is not being soft on performance. Coaching helps employees understand what to improve, how to improve it, and what action to take next.

Workshop Learning Objectives

- Explain the difference between pressure, feedback, and coaching.
- Identify common root causes of sales performance gaps.
- Use the S.C.O.R.E. Coaching Model to guide a structured coaching conversation.
- Ask coaching questions that help employees analyze sales situations and choose next actions.
- Practice a short coaching conversation using a realistic EuroBridge sales scenario.
- Create a two-week coaching action plan for your team.

Activity 1: Opening Reflection

Think of one recent conversation with an employee about sales performance. It may have been about low conversion, weak follow-up, client objections, or missed targets.

Prompt	Your Notes
What was the sales situation?	
What did you say first?	
Was the conversation mostly pressure, feedback, or coaching?	
What would you change if you had the conversation again?	

Activity 2: Pressure, Feedback, or Coaching?

Read the three examples. Label each one as pressure, feedback, or coaching. Then discuss which one is most likely to improve employee behavior.

Example	Type	Why?
You need to close more clients this week. Your number is too low. Find a way to fix it.		
In your last three calls, you explained the product features but did not ask enough questions about client needs.		
Let us look at the last client conversation. What was the client's main concern? Where did the conversation stop moving forward?		

My takeaway from this activity:

Activity 3: Sales Performance Gap Diagnosis

Poor sales results can come from different root causes. Before giving advice, diagnose the gap.

Gap Type	Description	Example
Product Knowledge Gap	Employee does not understand the product deeply enough.	Cannot explain a fixed income product clearly.
Market Understanding Gap	Employee struggles to connect product to market context.	Cannot explain why European energy prices matter.
Client Discovery Gap	Employee does not ask enough questions.	Jumps into product pitch too early.
Communication Gap	Employee explains unclearly or too aggressively.	Uses vague or high-pressure language.
Process Execution Gap	Employee does not follow up or track next steps.	No clear follow-up after client interest.
Mindset / Confidence Gap	Employee avoids difficult conversations.	Hesitates to discuss risk or objections.

Quick Match: Identify the likely gap.

Employee Situation	Likely Gap
Employee talks about product features but does not ask about client goals.	
Employee forgets to follow up after client asks for more information.	
Employee avoids explaining product risk because they fear the client will lose interest.	
Employee cannot explain the difference between FX and index exposure.	

Job Aid: S.C.O.R.E. Coaching Model

Step	Meaning	Manager Action	Sample Question
S	Situation	Clarify the specific sales situation.	What happened with this client?
C	Challenge	Identify the main obstacle or performance gap.	Where exactly did the conversation get stuck?
O	Options	Help the employee generate possible next actions.	What are two ways you could follow up?
R	Response	Agree on a concrete action.	What will you do before the next client touchpoint?
E	Evaluate	Review results and learning.	What did we learn from the follow-up?

Which step do I usually skip or rush?

Activity 4: Advice-Giving vs Coaching

Scenario: A sales employee has spoken to a client twice about a precious metals product, but the client has not moved forward. The employee says: "I think the client is just not interested. Maybe I should stop following up."

Manager Response	What does this response do?	What is missing?
Advice-giving: You should explain the safe-haven logic more clearly. Tell them gold is useful when the market is uncertain. Follow up again tomorrow.		
Coaching: Let us look at the conversation. What did the client ask about? What concern did you hear? Did they reject the product, or are they unsure about timing, risk, or value?		

Activity 5: Rewrite Directives into Coaching Questions

Rewrite each directive statement into a coaching question. Aim for questions that are specific, behavior-based, and action-oriented.

Directive Statement	Coaching Question
You need to follow up faster.	
Your product explanation is not clear.	
You are not asking enough questions.	
You should push harder.	

One coaching question I want to use this week:

Activity 6: S.C.O.R.E. Role Play

Choose one scenario. One person plays the manager, one person plays the sales employee, and one person observes if working in groups of three. Use S.C.O.R.E. to guide the conversation.

Scenario	Context
Client Discovery Gap	A sales employee keeps presenting European index products to clients, but clients often stop responding after the first conversation. Call notes show limited client discovery.
Risk Communication Gap	A sales employee avoids discussing risk because they are afraid the client will lose interest. As a result, the product explanation sounds too optimistic.
Follow-Up Gap	A sales employee has many initial conversations but few conversions. Follow-up steps are vague and often delayed.

Observer Checklist

Observed Behavior	Yes / No / Notes
Manager asked about the specific sales situation.	
Manager avoided jumping directly to advice.	
Manager helped identify the real challenge.	
Manager asked at least two open coaching questions.	
Manager guided employee toward a concrete next action.	
Manager agreed on a follow-up point.	

Manager Toolkit: Coaching Question Bank

S.C.O.R.E. Step	Questions You Can Use
Situation	What happened with this client? What was the client trying to understand? What did the client say or ask?
Challenge	Where did the conversation get stuck? What was the client concern? What information are we missing?
Options	What could you try next? What are two possible follow-up approaches? What question could reopen the conversation?
Response	What will you do next? By when? What message will you send or what call will you make?
Evaluate	What happened after the follow-up? What worked? What would you adjust next time?

Two-Week Coaching Action Plan

Choose one real coaching opportunity. Complete this plan before leaving the workshop.

Prompt	Your Response
One employee I will coach in the next two weeks	
The sales behavior I want to focus on	
Which S.C.O.R.E. step I need to use most intentionally	
One coaching question I will ask	
How I will follow up	
What evidence will show improvement	

Final takeaway:

Diagnose before coaching. Use questions before advice. Turn pressure into specific next action.